to appoint a joint Anglo-American Commission to prepare ideas for consideration in London and Washington.[3] None of the above was acceptable to the State Department who wanted to start discussions with experts from Russia and China and other countries in the expectation that a plan would emerge. The State Department had no objection to the British submitting the Clearing Union Plan to the Russians and Chinese. And that was the way it happened. Both the British and the American plans were given to the Russians and the Chinese. Later, the White plan was circulated to the Latin American and European Allies as well as to the Dominions.

On February 2, 1943, the Chancellor of the Exchequer in a speech delivered in the House of Commons gave in vague outline the currency system the Treasury wished to see established after the war. A month later on March 4, the Treasury announced in London that a conference was being were being held with Allied Finance Ministers to discuss currency arrangements in Europe after the war. Representatives of Russia, China, and the Dominions attended. A British communiqué stated that the Conference had been held under the Chairmanship of the Financial Secretary to the Treasury, Ralph Asheton. On the same day, Morgenthau sent copies of the Stabilization Fund proposal to the Finance Ministers of thirty-seven countries, inviting them to send experts 'to discuss with our technical experts the feasibility of international monetary cooperation along the lines suggested therein, or along any other lines you may wish to suggest.'[4]

All this could not be kept secret for long. It soon leaked out that a 'Keynes plan' had been distributed to the European Allies. Rumours about an American plan on the same subject also caused much speculation and curiosity. Questions were asked in the British Parliament and the Chancellor of the Exchequer wanted to take the State Department into confidence before making a statement on the floor of the House. Morgenthau asked Roosevelt for permission to inform Congress so as to avoid unnecessary and troublesome rumours. Roosevelt refused and finally it was decided that the Clearing Union plan would be published alone on April 8, 1943. Keynes thought it a good idea. 'The sooner steam is blown off, the better.'[5] But events took a different turn. On April 5, 1943, the London *Financial News* carried on its front page full details of the American plan. A defensive Phillips met Morgenthau who assured him that he had not for a moment thought that the British Treasury had had a hand in the leak. The source of